

POWER-PACKED Union Minister R.K. Singh with Group Editorial Director Raj Chengappa and Deputy Editor Anilesh S. Mahajan (left)

R.K. Singh *Union Minister of Power, and New and Renewable Energy*

Photographs by **RAJWANT RAWAT, HARDIK CHHABRA**

emissions by 33 per cent even though our emissions are one of the lowest. And we achieved that in 2019. We have already raised our ambition. We further want to cut emissions intensity by 45 per cent by 2030. We shall achieve that. We have programmes for that.

EXPECTATIONS FROM BIG EMITTERS

New Delhi resonates with the voice of the Global South. The developed countries are emitting at a faster pace—three times the global average. Eighty per cent of the total carbon dioxide load, which has caused a 1.1-degree rise in temperature, has been contributed by them having one-third population of the world. Our contribution is only 3 per cent even though our population is 17 per cent. So, 53 gigatonnes are being spewed out every year. Now, two-thirds of that is coming from developed countries. They need to bring it down. That's the voice of the Global South.

CUTTING DOWN COAL EMISSIONS

Let's not go to fuel or whatever. The end result is what we are looking at. So how much you are emitting, right? Because it's the emissions that are causing the global rise in temperature. If you are emitting at a certain rate, which is three times the global average, you need to bring down those emissions. You decide how you want to bring it down. ■



INDIA-JAPAN @2030

Hiroshi Suzuki
Ambassador of Japan to India

The Future of a Valued Partnership

Ambassador Suzuki outlines the ways to strengthen the ties between India and Japan

The Japanese ambassador to India, **Hiroshi Suzuki**, shared his thoughts on Japan's special partnership with India, stating that the relations between the two countries are based on three pillars—political and security, economic and cultural and people-to-people exchange. Japan and India share fundamental values, freedom, democracy, rule of law and strategic relations.

LEADERSHIP VISION

The Japan-India partnership was drastically pushed forward by two visionary leaders, PM Abe and PM Modi. They really propelled our ties to a higher plane, in strategic as well as global aspects.

ECONOMIC SECURITY

There is a dire necessity to reduce our dependence on a particular country for our needs like semiconductors, critical minerals and emerging technology. Now, looking ahead, the main challenge that India and Japan should tackle together is to address economic security.

INVESTMENT CLIMATE

To further promote Japanese investment, we would like to see continued endeavour from the Indian side to improve an enabling business environment. We are working as 'one team, one project' on the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High Speed rail corridor... Japan is also creating a new industrial value chain in India's northeast. We have plans to connect the region with Bangladesh's Matabari port, which will be a game-changer.

FOCUS ON EDUCATION

We are creating opportunities for young Indian talent to study in Japan. The embassy in New Delhi will tie up with Tokyo University, tasked by the Japanese education ministry, to promote Indian students going over to Japan to study. ■